GitHub Copilot now supports multiple large language models (LLMs)

GitHub is enhancing Copilot by integrating multiple large language models (LLMs), offering developers more flexibility and choice.

Since its launch, Copilot has leveraged various LLMs tailored for coding tasks. Initially powered by Codex, a fine-tuned version of OpenAI's GPT-3, Copilot evolved to include GPT-3.5 and later GPT-4 for Copilot Chat in 2023. More recent additions like GPT 3.5-turbo, GPT 4o, and GPT 4o-mini have provided developers with options balancing latency and quality.

Expanding further, Copilot now incorporates models from leading AI developers like Anthropic's Claude 3.5 Sonnet, Google's Gemini 1.5 Pro and OpenAI's o1-preview and o1-mini. OpenAI's o1-preview and o1-mini are already available in Copilot Chat, with Claude 3.5 Sonnet set to launch next week and Gemini 1.5 Pro rolling out in the coming weeks.

"The past year has witnessed a surge in high-quality small and large language models, each excelling in different programming tasks," stated Thomas Dohme, CEO of GitHub. "It's clear that the future of AI code generation will be defined not only by multi-model functionality but also by multi-model choice."

Developers working in VS Code or directly on GitHub.com can now choose models best suited to their needs, while enterprises can customise model selection for their teams.

Holistic launches open source library to address AI development risks

Holistic has introduced Holistic AI OSL, an open source library designed to mitigate risks in AI development and promote fairness and responsibility in AI systems.

Arriving as AI adoption expands into sensitive areas like recruitment, healthcare, and finance, the library targets critical issues such as bias, which remains a major concern for 65% of AI researchers and developers.

Holistic AI OSL addresses five key technical risks in AI development with tools for bias mitigation, offering over 35 bias metrics across five machine learning tasks and 30 mitigation strategies. It also enhances model explainability, enabling developers to better understand and articulate AI decision-making processes.

"Our new library equips organisations with tools for all AI risks, including explainability, robustness, and bias," explained Adriano Koshiyama, co-CEO of Holistic AI. "It supports measurement, reporting, and mitigation at every stage of the AI lifecycle."

Additionally, the toolkit focuses on system robustness, ensuring AI models maintain consistent performance even under adversarial conditions or data shifts.

OpenVINO 2024.5 released with better LLM/GenAI coverage

Intel has introduced OpenVINO 2024.5, a significant update to its cross-platform AI toolkit, enhancing generative AI (GenAI) capabilities and expanding support for large language models (LLMs). This release adds compatibility with Llama 3.2 (1B and 3B sizes), Gemma 2 (2B and 9B sizes), and YOLO11, along with LLM deployment support on Intel NPUs for models like Llama 3 8B, Llama 2 7B, Mistral-v0.2 7B, Qwen2 7B Instruct, and Phi-3. New optimisations target Intel Core Ultra graphics, Intel Arc GPUs, and the latest processors, including Intel Xeon 6 P-core (Granite Rapids) and Intel Core Ultra 200V Arrow Lake S desktop processors.

The update also introduces preview support for Flex, a Python neural network library based on JAX, speculative decoding for the GenAI API, and multi-modal pipeline support for AI deployments.

With these advancements, OpenVINO 2024.5 offers a comprehensive platform for developers to leverage cutting-edge AI solutions. Full details and downloads are available on GitHub, with performance benchmarks expected soon.

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